

CJ Rivas

Senior Frontend Engineer + Architect

Experienced Senior Frontend Engineer + Architect with nearly 20 years in the field, specializing in React and AI technologies. Committed to driving innovation through AI-powered development, with a proven record of leading initiatives that boost user engagement.

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TECHNICAL SKILLS

TypeScript	JavaScript	React	AI Tooling/LLM	Claude/Codex/Cursor	Next.js	Vue.js	Node.js
Design Systems	Emotion/Styled Components	SCSS/CSS	Redux/Zustand	Vite/Webpack/Rollup	Storybook		
Jest/Vitest	Playwright	Bun/NPM/Yarn	Git	CI/CD	Responsive Design	E2E Testing	REST API

WORK EXPERIENCE

— Senior Frontend Engineer

09/2024 - 05/2026

The Globe and Mail

- Developed interactive React components integrated with a proprietary CMS, boosting reader engagement and streamlining content management.
- Embedded AI tooling into daily development and code reviews, raising code quality and cutting review turnaround time.
- Improved frontend maintainability through targeted refactoring and expanded unit test coverage.
- Built a Storybook-based design system for React components, strengthening consistency and team collaboration.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to deliver high-quality features on schedule.

— Fullstack Engineer

11/2023 - Present

iPolitics

- Served as the sole full-stack developer for two Next.js/React/Prisma/Sanity news sites (iPolitics and QP Briefing), owning the backend, CI/CD, and infrastructure end-to-end.
- Diagnosed and resolved Sanity.io CMS issues, keeping both newsrooms publishing without interruption.
- Led a tiered TypeScript migration of both codebases, backed by Vitest test coverage.
- Implemented TanStack Query, Zustand, and Zod for data fetching, global state, and schema validation across a consistent, well-organized React codebase.

— Principal Robot

06/2024 - 09/2024

Robots and Pencils

- Managed the ASU project lifecycle end-to-end, implementing new features and ensuring timely delivery.
- Conducted pull request reviews, upholding code quality and reinforcing team best practices.
- Identified and implemented UI/UX improvements, refining features based on user testing feedback to sharpen interface performance.

— Senior Frontend Engineer

03/2024 - 05/2024

XP Ventures Labs

- Led the conversion of a legacy React JavaScript application into modular TypeScript micro-frontends, modernizing the architecture and enabling independent deployments.
- Migrated global state from Redux to Zustand and refactored components to modern React patterns, improving performance and reducing complexity.
- Designed and implemented a CI/CD pipeline with automated linting, formatting, unit, and E2E tests, accelerating development cycles.
- Championed TypeScript and React best practices through code reviews and updated team standards, elevating code quality.
- Reduced technical debt and optimized frontend tooling, improving developer experience across the team.

— Senior Frontend Engineer + Architect

06/2022 - 11/2023

Radian

- Served as Frontend Lead Architect for homegeniusrealestate.com, leading frontend development from scratch to production with Next.js, TypeScript, GraphQL, and Nest.js.
- Delivered the complete real estate platform to market in under one year.
- Designed a scalable React design system with Storybook for component-driven development.
- Managed an NX monorepo with Docker and enforced standards through code reviews and mentoring.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams on advanced search, interactive maps, and user dashboards.
- Optimized performance through code splitting, lazy loading, and efficient GraphQL queries, achieving superior Core Web Vitals scores.
- Reduced technical debt and established frontend best practices for faster development and long-term maintainability.

— Senior Frontend Engineer + Architect

01/2021 - 06/2022

Varicent

- Collaborated directly with the CTO as Frontend Architect, migrating React JavaScript components to TypeScript across projects to improve maintainability and type safety.
- Overhauled the webpack configuration and migrated builds to Vite and esbuild, cutting build times significantly.
- Conducted performance testing and implemented key frontend optimizations.
- Implemented an NX monorepo with custom bash scripts, streamlining the development workflow.
- Optimized GitHub workflows through parallelization and smart caching.
- Prototyped experimental modules and components to explore emerging frontend approaches.

— Senior Frontend Engineer

12/2020 - 02/2021

Myplanet

- Developed an internal TypeScript toolset that streamlined website and application production by automating repetitive frontend tasks.
- Built a suite of reusable React component libraries to accelerate delivery across product teams.
- Maintained a Lerna-managed monorepo to coordinate versioning and dependency management across packages.
- Curated a Storybook-driven design system, organizing themes and themeable components to ensure visual consistency at scale.

— Senior Frontend Engineer

08/2020 - 12/2020

RBC Capital Markets

- Engineered a real-time stock trading application leveraging React Hooks, TypeScript, and RxJS to deliver reactive market data streams.
- Authored comprehensive unit test coverage across React components to safeguard performance and stability.
- Established code quality standards by integrating ESLint and Prettier into the development workflow.
- Strengthened the DevOps pipeline with additional automated checks, accelerating build times and improving deployment confidence.

— Lead Frontend Engineer

08/2019 - 08/2020

RBC Ventures

- Planned and developed new frontend features for the admin app, enabling efficient user management.
- Migrated the app from its legacy React architecture to a custom framework built on React Hooks.
- Optimized UI experience and performance through webpack chunking, lazy loading, and in-memory data caching.
- Mentored new team members and demoed new features to stakeholders.
- Maintained the CI workflow and created custom bash scripts to streamline the development process.

— Frontend Team Lead

12/2018 - 08/2019

Toronto Star

- Maintained and enhanced thestar.com in React, leading development of a new responsive main menu.
- Acted as lead developer, owning pull request reviews and merges to uphold code quality, site performance, and user experience.
- Introduced E2E testing integrated with Jenkins and real-time error monitoring with Sentry.io.
- Identified workflow issues and proposed solutions to optimize team processes.
- Interviewed frontend developer candidates to help build a strong team.
- Worked in an agile, continuous-delivery environment, consistently meeting project deadlines.

— Senior Frontend Engineer

05/2016 - 04/2018

The Globe and Mail

- Developed and maintained website features using vanilla JavaScript.
- Collaborated with the frontend team to build highly performant, responsive components.
- Implemented accessible semantic markup and advanced analytics to enhance the user experience.
- Participated in code reviews and documented UI best practices and code standards to uphold quality.
- Increased unit test coverage, improving code stability and reducing bugs.
- Presented a Git workflow session to the internal team, increasing team efficiency.

— Senior Frontend Engineer

01/2016 - 05/2016

theScore

- Developed a fantasy sports application using Ember.js, delivering interactive features for end users.
- Collaborated within an agile team environment, contributing to iterative development and sprint planning.
- Conducted code reviews on pull requests and supported continuous integration workflows to uphold code quality.
- Expanded backend proficiency by self-studying Ruby on Rails, broadening full-stack capabilities.

— Frontend Team Lead

11/2014 - 01/2016

Rogers

- Developed a Rogers web application and established AngularJS coding conventions adopted by all developers.
- Conducted technical interviews to assess candidates' AngularJS expertise, ensuring strong additions to the team.
- Designed an AngularJS module framework that facilitated collaboration and was adopted across multiple teams.
- Expanded Bootstrap's AngularUI directives and documented frontend solutions, ensuring all code was thoroughly unit tested.
- Built custom Node and Gulp modules and mentored junior developers through hands-on code pairing.

— Intermediate Frontend Developer

04/2014 - 11/2014

Uptime Software

- Served as the sole frontend specialist for a company-wide computer and server monitoring application built with AngularJS.
- Implemented a Test-Driven Development (TDD) workflow using Jasmine, Karma, and Protractor.
- Contributed shell scripts for continuous integration in Bamboo.
- Consumed a proprietary RESTful API layer to build out the graphical user interface.
- Owned all frontend build tooling, including custom Gulp tasks.

— Intermediate Frontend Developer

02/2012 - 03/2014

Kobo Inc.

- Contributed to the development of Kobo's Instant Reader web application, built on the SproutCore JavaScript framework.
- Diagnosed and resolved frontend defects while delivering new features across the reading experience.
- Partnered with the design and UX team to implement responsive layouts that performed consistently across all supported platforms.
- Maintained and iterated on kobobooks.com, working in lockstep with backend engineers to ship full-scale, site-wide improvements.
- Collaborated cross-functionally with adjacent teams to investigate issues and research new feature opportunities.

— Senior Flash Developer + Team Lead

07/2008 - 09/2011

Research Now

- Architected a global Flash framework that powered Research Now's custom survey tooling across international markets.
- Engaged directly with clients to gather requirements and scope custom development work.
- Owned the architecture and visual design of all Flash and Flex applications.
- Led the North American Flash team and mentored a junior Flash developer across most project deliveries.
- Built custom interactive survey applications tailored to client research objectives.
- Authored a proprietary ActionScript 3 library grounded in object-oriented principles to standardize internal development.
- Refactored core classes and components to maximize reusability across the project portfolio.
- Delivered a Flex-based real-time survey reporting application that surfaced live respondent insights.

AWARDS

LANGUAGES

EDUCATION

Digital Media Arts

Service Excellence - FE

mobileLIVE · 2015

Above and Beyond

The Globe and Mail · 2017

English

Native or Bilingual Proficiency

Spanish

Native or Bilingual Proficiency

Seneca College of Applied Arts and
Technology